staynest.

FRONTEND IDENTITY & EXPERIENCE STANDARDS

Make room for *somewhere* wonderful.

A practical brand guide for the digital StayNest experience: calm discovery, thoughtful spaces, and a stay that feels like yours.



01

A softer way to find your place.

PURPOSE
Define StayNest's promise, audience, and character.

WHY IT MATTERS
A shared identity makes every page feel like one thoughtful host.

HOW TO APPLY IT
Use these traits to guide copy, visual choices, and product decisions.

What the brand promises

We help guests find a place that fits the shape of their trip, then make the path from browsing to booking feel clear and reassuring.

> **Brand idea**
> Thoughtful stays, made easy to find.

Who we serve

City visitors, remote workers, families, couples, and longer-stay guests who value welcoming spaces, honest details, and predictable booking steps.

CHARACTER

Warm, not sugary. Refined, not formal.

Our interface should feel like a good host: attentive, quietly confident, and generous with useful information.

- **Welcoming** — personal language, never overfamiliar
- **Grounded** — real places and concrete details
- **Composed** — clear hierarchy, uncluttered controls
- **Trustworthy** — transparent pricing and status

Messaging principles

01
Lead with the place

Name the stay, location, price, capacity, and what makes it distinctive.

02
Use human words

Prefer "Find your next stay" to generic product or software language.

03
Keep promises precise

Never call a reservation confirmed until payment and booking status are verified.

02

Garnet, paper, and a note of coral.

PURPOSE
Assign a clear role to every brand colour.

WHY IT MATTERS
Consistent contrast keeps photography expressive and controls easy to read.

HOW TO APPLY IT
Use tokens by role, then check contrast on real screens.

Charcoal ink
`#302D2C · primary text`

Bright berry
`#9E6268 · actions, section fields`

Soft berry
`#B77778 · hero fallback, secondary depth`

Coral accent
`#D97967 · punctuation, markers`

Soft blush
`#F1D8D2 · pale highlight`

Cool paper
`#F8F7F5 · canvas`

Supporting neutrals

ROLE	VALUE	USE
Muted text	#76716F	Descriptions, helper text
Navigation	#5D5857	Secondary links
Hairline	#E8E4E1	Dividers, borders
Soft field	#F5ECE9	Subtle badges and quiet areas

Application rules

- Use charcoal ink for body text on the cool paper canvas.
- Use bright berry for primary actions and broad brand surfaces.
- Coral is an accent, not a paragraph-text color.
- Use white for card surfaces and reverse text on bright berry.
- Use warm red for errors and cool blue for success feedback.

Contrast note Coral and blush are accent colours, not small-text colours. Use charcoal or bright berry text on pale blush, and white text on bright berry only after checking contrast for the chosen type size.

03

Editorial feeling. Everyday clarity.

PURPOSE
Separate expressive headlines from functional information.

WHY IT MATTERS
A clear type hierarchy supports both emotion and fast comparison.

HOW TO APPLY IT
Reserve Playfair for display; use DM Sans for interface and body copy.

DISPLAY · PLAYFAIR DISPLAY, 600

Find your place in the *world.*

Use for the homepage hero, section statements, property titles, and auth image message. Keep lines short and natural.

INTERFACE · DM SANS, 400–700

Thoughtfully selected apartments for your stay.

Use for body copy, navigation, controls, labels, pricing, metadata, statuses, and admin tools.

Recommended web scale

STYLE	FONT	SIZE / LEADING	APPLICATION
Hero headline	Playfair Display 600	48–76 px / 1.05	Homepage lead statement
Page title	Playfair Display 600	42 px / 1.12	Property and dashboard heading
Section title	Playfair Display 600	32–42 px / 1.15	Collection and promise sections
Card title	Playfair Display 600	18–22 px / 1.25	Apartment cards
Body	DM Sans 400	14 px / 1.6	Descriptions and explanatory copy
Control	DM Sans 600	12–14 px / 1.3	Buttons, menus, form text
Eyebrow	DM Sans 700	10 px / uppercase	Section marker; use sparingly

Typesetting principles

- Use sentence case for headings and actions.
- Set uppercase labels in short, tracked phrases only.
- Use italics to emphasize a single phrase, not whole paragraphs.
- Let the font scale respond to layout, never create cramped line lengths.

Fallback stack

Playfair Display, Georgia, serif

DM Sans, Arial, sans-serif

Fonts are loaded from Google Fonts in the current frontend.

04

Show the real reason to stay.

PURPOSE
Make the actual apartment the visual centre of discovery.

WHY IT MATTERS
Honest imagery helps guests assess fit and builds booking confidence.

HOW TO APPLY IT
Choose clear, useful views and keep crops, quality, and alt text consistent.



Image direction

- Lead with a clear, wide view of the actual room or property.
- Prefer natural light, honest perspective, lived-in but uncluttered details.
- Show distinct spaces: living room, bedroom, kitchen, exterior, view.
- Use consistent quality and crop treatment across the listing collection.
- Hero photography uses a lighter garnet wash so the room stays visible while white text remains readable.

Crop and treatment

- Property cards: landscape crop, consistent frame, focal point remains visible.
- Detail page: wide cover image with space to inspect the property.
- Authentication: immersive full-height photograph with subtle dark wash.
- Avoid heavy blur, artificial gradients over photos, or unrelated stock imagery.
- Write useful alt text describing the scene, not repeating “image of”.

Where imagery appears

01 · DISCOVERY
Large hero image signals the product. Cards use consistent landscape property photography.

02 · EVALUATION
A prominent detail cover supports a considered decision before a guest reserves.

03 · ACCOUNT
A single immersive image adds warmth to sign-in without competing with the form.

05

A clear journey, from browse to book.

PURPOSE
Structure a guest's journey from discovery through reservation.

WHY IT MATTERS
Predictable information order lowers effort and supports confident decisions.

HOW TO APPLY IT
Show relevant property facts before asking guests to take action.

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Explore stays My bookings Log in

Homepage rhythm

1. Sticky, quiet navigation with clear account access.
2. Immersive photo hero with a short promise and one exploration action.
3. Search surface overlaps the hero edge and has clearly labelled fields.
4. Three-column property collection at desktop; single-column on narrow screens.
5. Promise statement, concise benefits, then one final invitation.

Property card anatomy



VICTORIA ISLAND · LAGOS

Palm Court Residence

3 bedrooms · 2 baths · up to 6 guests

₦110,000 / night View details →

Page pattern map

PAGE	PRIMARY JOB	VISUAL EMPHASIS	KEY INTERACTION
Home	Discover and filter stays	Photography, editorial hero	Search and compare
Property detail	Evaluate a specific apartment	Title, location, large image, nightly price	Select dates/guests; reserve
Sign in / register	Access an account	Split image and focused form	One clear submit action
Guest dashboard	Review reservations	Compact list rows and status	Inspect or cancel booking
Admin	Manage inventory and bookings	Dense, scan-friendly operations	Create, edit, remove, review

Spacing system Use the current generous section rhythm (about 96–100 px vertical padding), 24–36 px page gutters, 22 px card gaps, and 12–20 px control/card padding. Reduce space on mobile without collapsing the hierarchy.

06

Quiet controls. Confident decisions.

PURPOSE
Make recurring controls and feedback feel consistent.

WHY IT MATTERS
Familiar patterns reduce errors and make each action easier to understand.

HOW TO APPLY IT
Use clear labels, restrained icons, stable states, and purposeful surfaces.

Buttons

Find your stay Cancel

- Primary: bright berry fill, white text, concise verb-led label.
- Secondary: outlined or text treatment; use for reversible, lower-priority actions.
- Keep buttons stable in size and label; show busy state without shifting layout.
- Do not append decorative arrows to every button.

Forms and feedback

- Labels remain visible above fields; never rely on placeholder alone.
- Use native date, numeric, and select controls when they fit the task.
- Put validation near the field or action that needs attention.
- Errors use restrained warm red; success uses cool blue with explicit text.
- Show pending, confirmed, cancelled, and failed states in words.

Iconography

Use a consistent outline family (Lucide is already in the frontend). Keep icons small, aligned, and subordinate to labels. Reserve icon-only buttons for familiar actions and provide accessible names/tooltips. Remove decorative duplication from wordmarks, field rows, and amenity lists.

Surface and shape

Cards are functional containers, not decoration. Use white surfaces, fine warm-grey borders, restrained shadows, and small corner radii. Avoid nested cards and excessive pill styling.

Voice examples

PREFER	AVOID
“Find your place in the world.”	“The ultimate accommodation solution”
“₦85,000 per night”	Unexplained totals or hidden fees
“Your reservation is confirmed.”	Claiming success before verification
“No apartments match those filters.”	“Oops! Nothing here!”

Motion

Motion should clarify rather than entertain: a subtle image hover, a restrained menu reveal, or a loading state. Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`; never make essential information depend on animation.

07

Make the calm work for everyone.

PURPOSE

Set a baseline for accessible, responsive product experiences.

WHY IT MATTERS

Inclusive patterns work across devices, abilities, and real usage conditions.

HOW TO APPLY IT

Use the checklist during design, implementation, and release review.

Accessibility checklist

- Maintain readable contrast for body and control text.
- Use semantic headings, buttons, links, forms, and landmarks.
- Give every input a programmatic label and every image useful alt text.
- Make focus visible and keep all interactions keyboard-operable.
- Do not communicate booking state through colour alone.
- Respect reduced motion and zoom/reflow at 200%.
- Keep tap targets comfortable on touch screens.

Responsive behaviour

- Desktop: three property columns, horizontal search row, split auth.
- Tablet: simplify navigation and reduce columns before content gets cramped.
- Mobile: one-column listings, stacked search controls, clear form spacing.
- Keep the property title, price, and primary reservation action easy to find.
- Prevent long city names, prices, and buttons from overflowing.

Design tokens for product work

TOKEN	VALUE	WHERE TO APPLY
Color / ink	#302D2C	Body copy and high-contrast type
Color / action	#9E6268	Primary buttons and dark bands
Color / paper	#F8F7F5	App canvas and navigation
Color / coral	#D97967	Accent dot, selected highlights
Font / display	Playfair Display	Editorial headings and property names
Font / interface	DM Sans	Everything interactive and informational
Content width	1168–1240 px	Centered page shell
Card image	245 px desktop	Consistent listing crop

Current implementation notes

- **Wordmark drift:** the current React header/footer render only a dot; restore the lowercase “staynest” wordmark with the coral period for a complete identity.
- **Image consistency:** retain the existing property photography approach and ensure every listing has a meaningful image and alt label.
- **Payment messaging:** product copy must match the implemented payment and confirmation flow; remove demo-only claims when checkout is active.